

Literature • Realistic

Grade	1	Word Count	374
Lexile	490L	Multi-level	N/A
Learning A–Z	level J		

Refer to the Focus Question on page 2 of this title to guide discussion and support additional learning connected to the text.

When the narrator decides to play soccer inside his house, he breaks his mom's favorite vase and blames his dog for it. **I Broke It** describes what happens when the main character lies about his actions and how he ultimately solves his problem.


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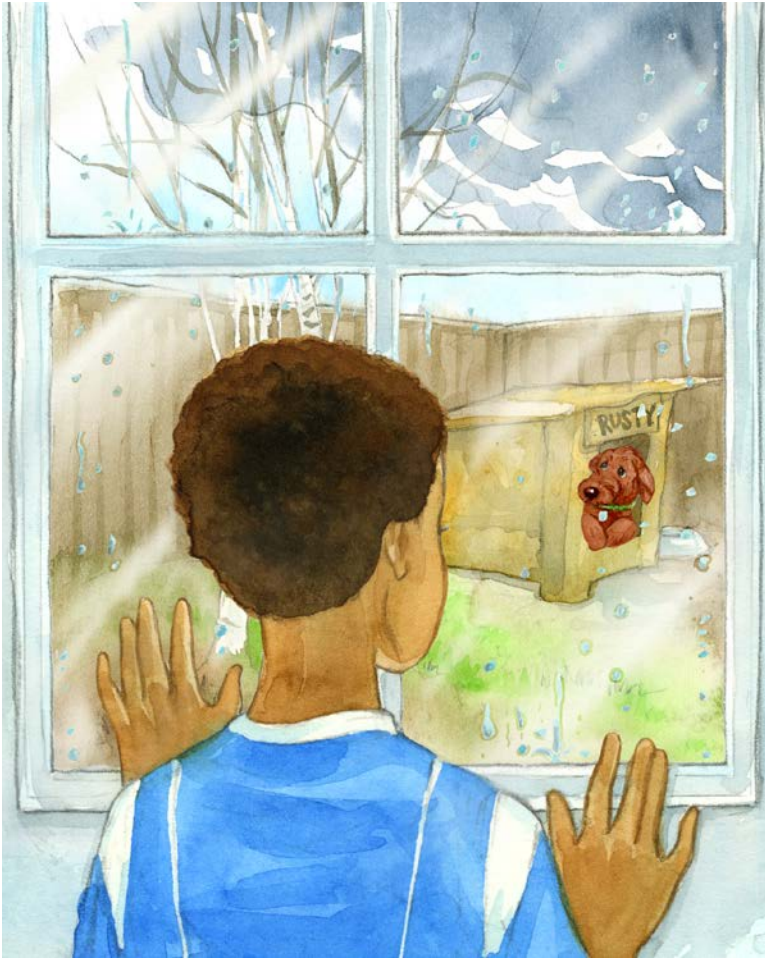
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I Broke It



Written by Edie Evans
Illustrated by Nicole Tadgell

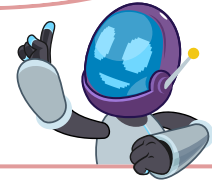
I Broke It



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Focus Question

What was the main problem in the story, and how was it solved?



Words to Know

blaming
fess
guilty

punished
shame
slumps

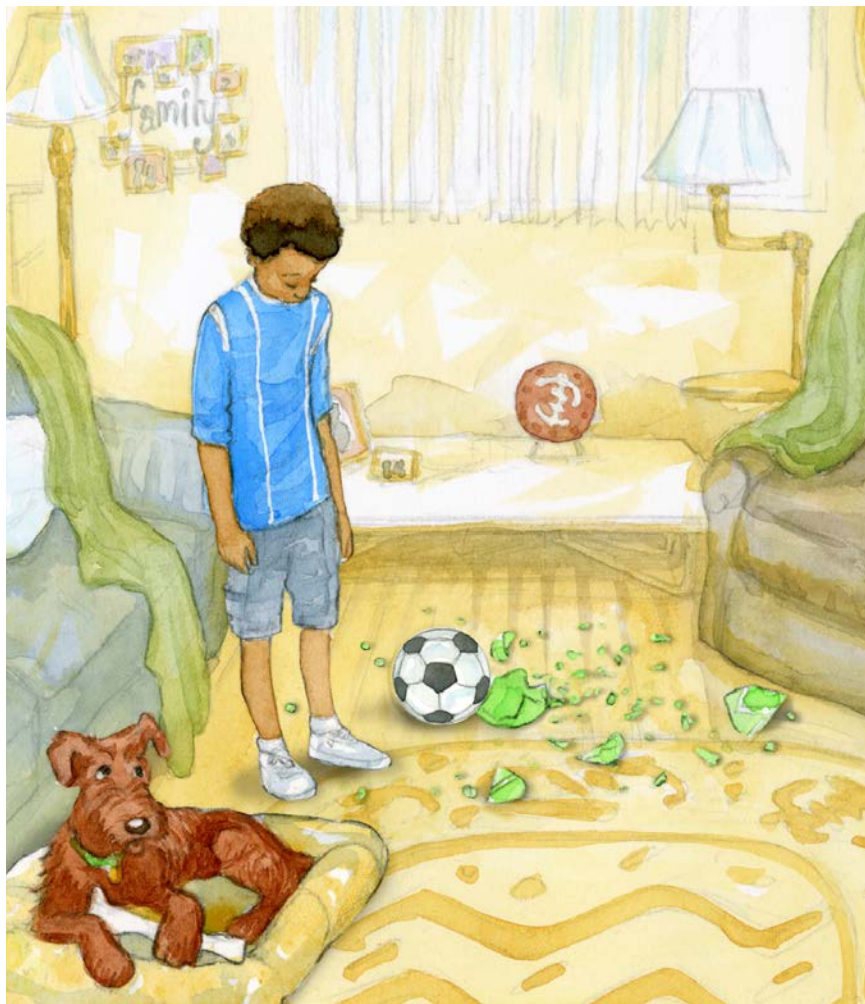
Connections

Writing

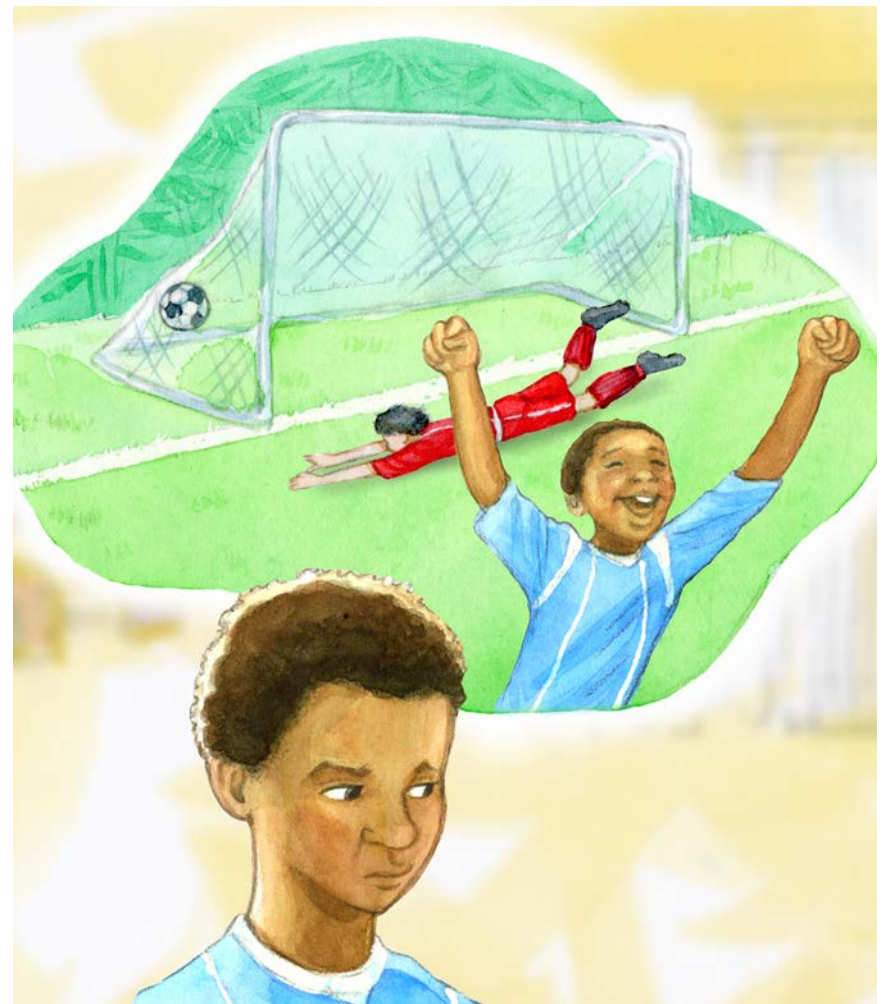
Imagine you are the main character and lied about Rusty breaking the vase. Write Rusty an apology letter explaining why you lied and why you ended up telling the truth.

Art

Draw a picture of a time you were honest. Show how you felt when you told the truth. Share your drawing with a partner.



I stare at the broken vase
on the floor.
It was Mom's favorite.
Now it's in a million pieces.
It was silly to play soccer inside.



I wasn't thinking about that, though.
Saturday is my team's final match.
I just wanted to practice a
little more.
Now I'm in big trouble!



Rusty thinks I'm playing—
not cleaning up the vase.
He jumps up and down,
barking happily.
This gives me an idea.



I hear a key turn in the door,
and Mom walks in.
Rusty jumps up to greet Mom,
his tail wagging.
“Hi, Rusty. Are you a good boy?”
she asks, patting him on the head.



“I’m sorry, Mom, but Rusty broke
your vase,” I lie, looking at my feet.
“Rusty, you go outside until you calm
down,” she says.
Rusty whines.
A sick feeling rises in my belly.



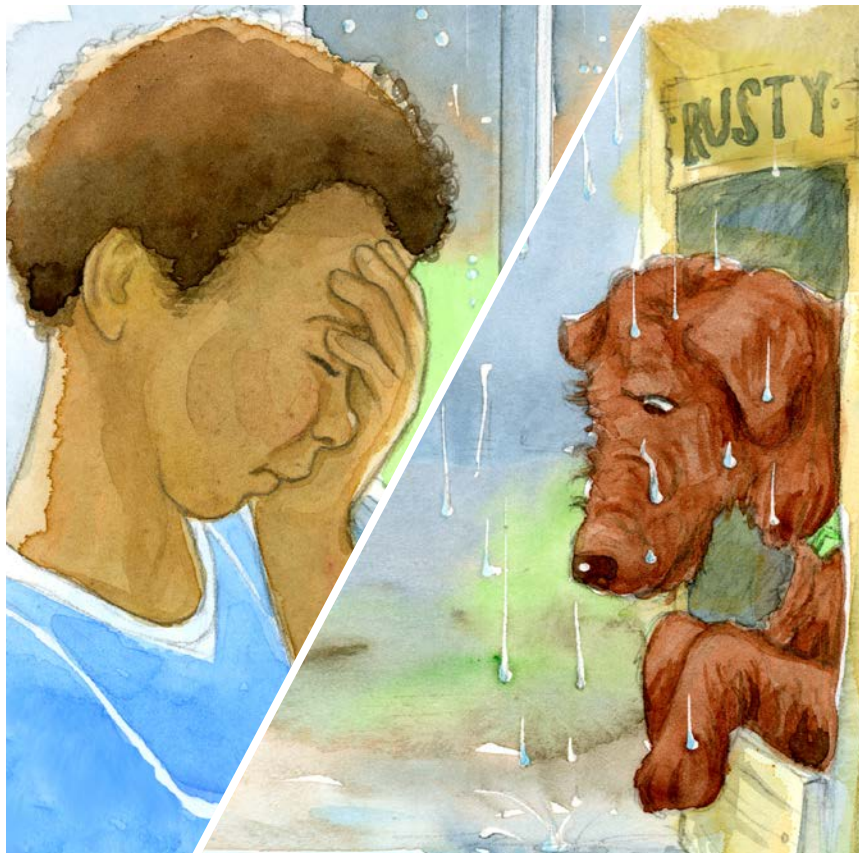
Still, I hold the door open.
Rusty curls his tail between
his legs in **shame**.
“Go to your doghouse, Rusty,”
I say.



Rusty **slumps** to his doghouse,
looking sad.
I close the door and try to think
about something else.
Then it begins to rain—hard.



I can't help but look out
the window.
From his doghouse, Rusty looks back
at me.
That sick feeling in my belly grows.



Rusty peeks out sadly.
 I feel sad, too, and **guilty**.
What have I done? I ask myself.
 Rusty is being **punished** because
 of my lie.
 I'm the one who ought to be
 punished.



I know Mom would tell me I should
fess up, so I do.
 I say, "Mom, I have something
 to tell you."
 "I was playing soccer in the
 house, and I broke the vase,"
 I quietly explain.



“Why did you lie?” she asks.

“I was scared to own up to my mistake,” I admit.

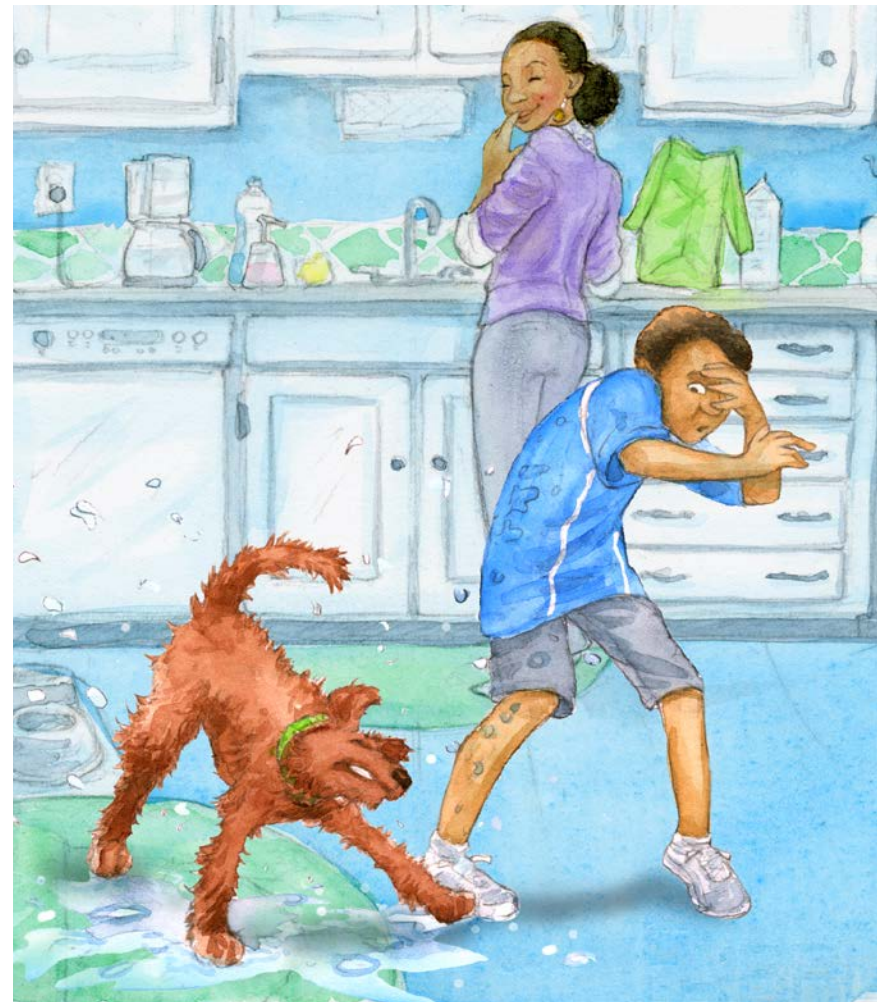
“And how did lying make you feel?” she asks.

“Guilty. Sad. Terrible,” I say.

She nods.

“**Blaming** Rusty for your mistake was wrong,” Mom says.

“Thank you for being honest,” she adds.



“Let Rusty back inside now,” she says.

I open the door, and Rusty runs back in.

He shakes the rain off his fur, right onto me.



He jumps up and gives me
a big lick.
Suddenly, my belly feels fine.
So does the rest of me.

Glossary

blaming (*v.*) page 13

believing or saying someone is responsible for a mistake or problem

fess (*v.*) page 12

short for “confess”; to admit or state that one has done something wrong

guilty (*adj.*) page 11

affected by a feeling of having done something wrong

punished (*v.*) page 11

made to pay for doing something wrong

shame (*n.*) page 8

a strong feeling of regret, sadness, or guilt caused by knowing or believing one has done something wrong

slumps (*v.*) page 9

sits, stands, or walks with a stooped or rounded posture